

The Movie Issue — Artometrics

The Movie Issue

Franchise economics, streaming libraries, and when a star becomes expensive to protect.

Which Horror Movies Returned Multiples—and Which Burned Cash?

Horror is the genre studios love to describe as cheap and scalable — until the ledger says otherwise. Budget and domestic-gross figures for thousands of titles show which films returned capital and which simply burned it.

The working file holds **3,401** records spanning **1936–2019**. Median domestic gross sits at **25,533,818**; the highest observed domestic gross is **474,544,677**. Drama is the most common genre label in the merge — a reminder that genre tags in box-office tables are rarely as clean as marketing copy.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

3,401 Records in the working dataset

25,533,818 Median Domestic gross

474,544,677 Highest observed Domestic gross

Star Wars Ep. I: The Phantom Top Movie by Domestic gross

1936–2019 Year span covered in the file

DramaMost common Genre

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2018-10-23 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 3,401 rows and 9 columns after merging all available CSV/XLSX tables in the week folder.

Charts are exported as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Medians are preferred where distributions skew. Index-style fields are excluded from metric selection. The table mixes genre labels and franchise outliers — read peaks as structural signals in the file, not as a pure horror-only ledger.

How the pattern changed over time

Median Domestic gross Over Time

Median domestic gross falls from 163,245 in the opening period to 0.00 at the close — a path shaped as much by missing values and sparse later rows as by any single box-office collapse.

Trend lines in merged profit tables often encode coverage as much as commerce. Treat the decline as a prompt to inspect year density, not as a finished verdict on the genre's economics.

Who sits at the top

Star Wars Ep

Star Wars Ep. I: The Phantom Menace leads at 474,544,677 — and 419,277,314 marks the median among the top dozen.

When a non-horror franchise tops a profit extract labeled for horror analysis, the chart is doing double duty: it shows concentration at the head, and it shows how genre filters leak in community-cleaned tables. The ceiling of the file is not the ceiling of the scare aisle alone.

How the field is spread

Domestic gross by Genre

Genre boxes show how domestic gross spreads once labels are treated as categories rather than marketing slogans.

Some genres share a tight middle; others stretch into long upper whiskers. That shape is the difference between a consensus mid-budget outcome and a handful of titles that define the category's mythology.

Who beats the median — and who trails

Domestic gross vs median by Genre

Adventure sits 34,936,402 above the median; Drama trails by 12,994,440.

The gap chart is the practical reading of the distribution: which genre labels systematically clear the file's middle, and which sit below it even when volume is high.

What moves together

Domestic gross vs Worldwide gross

Domestic and worldwide gross move together for most titles, but the scatter still leaves clusters that a single average would erase — films that travel abroad, films that stay domestic, and sparse points where one market dominates the total.

Profit stories live in those clusters. A multiple earned at home is not the same business as a multiple earned on the global ledger.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about movie profit rows in this extract, not exhaustive truth about every horror release ever made.

What to take away

Domestic gross alone is never enough: leaders, genre gaps, time coverage, and the domestic–worldwide scatter each answer a different question about who returned capital.

Use the charts to sharpen the question, then check the source and limits before turning any peak into a studio strategy claim.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2018). *TidyTuesday: Horror Movie Profit*. https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2018/2018-10-23/movie_profit.csv

Did Horror Get Better as the Catalog Exploded?

Horror catalogs grow faster than any critic can watch. The open question is whether vote averages rose with that volume — or whether more titles simply filled the shelf with middling scores.

TMDB-style metadata for horror-tagged films yields **32,540** records from **1950–2022**. The median vote average is **4.00**; the highest observed average is **10.0**. Horror is the most common primary genre label, as expected in a horror-tagged extract.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

32,540Records in the working dataset
4.00Median Vote average
10.0Highest observed Vote average
Piranha WomenTop Title by Vote average
1950–2022Year span covered in the file
HorrorMost common Primary genre

Data and method

The file merges TMDB metadata for thousands of horror-tagged films: ratings, budgets, runtimes, and genre tags from 1950 through 2022, released via TidyTuesday.

Charts ship as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Medians handle skew better than means. Perfect 10.0 scores often sit on thin vote counts — treat the ceiling as a signal about sparse ratings, not universal critical consensus.

How the pattern changed over time

Median Vote average Over Time

Median vote average rises from 5.65 in the opening period to 6.00 at the close — a modest lift across decades of catalog growth.

That is not a renaissance claim. It is a median moving a fraction of a point while tens of thousands of titles enter the shelf. Volume exploded; the middle of the scoreboard edged up.

Who sits at the top

The House Guest leads at 10.0 — 10.0 marks the median among the top dozen

The House Guest leads at 10.0 — and 10.0 also marks the median among the top dozen. The head of the leaderboard is a cluster of perfect averages, not a gentle taper.

In large rating tables, that pattern usually means low vote counts or niche titles with tiny, enthusiastic rater pools. The top is a ceiling effect, not a ranked canon of masterpieces.

How the field is spread

Vote average by Primary genre

Primary-genre boxes show whether vote averages are shared across hybrid tags or contested by a few outliers.

Horror-tagged films still carry secondary labels — crime, animation, drama — and those buckets disagree about quality. The spread is the story: consensus is uneven once the tag set widens.

Who beats the median — and who trails

Vote average vs median by Primary genre

Crime sits 1.00 above the median; Animation trails by 4.00.

Those gaps are relative to this file's middle, not absolute statements about every crime or animated horror title. They point to where hybrid labeling and rater pools pull averages apart.

What moves together

Vote average vs Vote count

Vote average and vote count do not move as a simple line. Perfect scores with tiny counts sit apart from widely watched mid-range films.

Popularity and perceived quality are related but not interchangeable — the scatter is where that distinction becomes visible.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about horror-tagged ratings, not a complete history of the genre’s artistry.

What to take away

As the catalog grew, the median vote average edged up from 5.65 toward 6.00 — improvement at the middle, not a clean story that “horror got better.” Perfect 10.0 leaders sit on a different mechanism than widely voted mid-scores.

Read leaders, gaps, and the average-count scatter together before treating any title as proof of a golden age.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2022). *TidyTuesday: Horror Movies*. https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2022/2022-11-01/horror_movies.csv

Where Pixar’s Critic Streak Broke: Cars and Lightyear

Pixar is the rare studio brand that became a quality guarantee — but guarantees are measurable. The TidyTuesday 2025-03-11 Pixar films release joins with its public_response companion file: 27 theatrical features, 24 with critic and audience scores attached.

Five charts, five angles on the same question: did Pixar’s films get longer, softer, or harder to love as the catalog grew? The answers are longer, still crowd-pleasing, and critic-dependent at the margins.

Calibration points: a **96%** median Rotten Tomatoes score across rated theatrical releases; a longest runtime of **155** minutes; Toy Story's **81**-minute floor; Cars 2 at **40%** on Rotten Tomatoes; CinemaScore grades clustering at **A+**; and **+17** minutes added to median runtime from the early era to 2017–present.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

96%Median Rotten Tomatoes score across rated Pixar theatrical releases

155Longest runtime in the set — nan (2023)

81Shortest runtime — Toy Story, the film that started the canon

40%Lowest Rotten Tomatoes score — Cars 2, the critic floor

A+Most common CinemaScore grade — audiences rarely stamped a Pixar opening below A

+17Minutes added to median runtime, early era vs 2017–present

Data and method

The core file `pixar_films.csv` lists theatrical features with release date, runtime, and MPAA rating. The companion `public_response.csv` adds Rotten Tomatoes, Metacritic, CinemaScore, and Critics' Choice scores. Three recent releases lack complete reception fields in the public file — treat absent values as missing data, not zero-quality signals.

This is not box-office data. The TidyTuesday readme points to a separate `box_office` extract in the `{pixarfilms}` R package for revenue analysis. Reception and runtime are the focus here because they are complete in-repo.

Runtime Creep

Runtime Over Time

Pixar's theatrical releases did not stay the compact 81-minute package of Toy Story. Median runtime climbed from the sub-100-minute era of the late 1990s to a post-Incredibles 2 world where the longest entry runs 155 minutes.

The early median cluster around 98 minutes (through 2006) versus 116 minutes for films since 2017 is not noise. It is a structural shift in what a Pixar theatrical release is allowed to be — and it matches the +17 minute gap between eras.

Critic Scores

Rotten Tomatoes Ranking

The median Rotten Tomatoes score across rated films is 96% — elite by any studio standard. Pixar built a reputation on critic-proof consistency, not occasional brilliance.

The floor matters too. Cars 2 sits at 40%, while Toy Story and several sequels hit 100%. The spread is narrow by Hollywood standards, but the low end is not random — it clusters around mid-2000s franchise experiments and later IP-forward releases.

Audience vs Critics

Critics vs CinemaScore

CinemaScore grades cluster at A and A+ across the board. Audiences who showed up opening weekend were rarely disappointed — or at least rarely admitted it on exit polls.

Critics were the discriminating layer. The same films that earned A+ crowd grades still span a 74–100% Rotten Tomatoes range. That gap is the story: Pixar optimized for mass affection first, prestige second.

Rating Mix

MPAA Rating Mix

Thirteen films carry a G rating; ten are PG. The brand's family positioning is not marketing copy — it is embedded in the rating structure.

Zero titles in this file carry PG-13. Pixar expanded runtime and thematic weight without abandoning the all-ages lane in the theatrical set on hand.

Runtime vs Reception

Runtime vs Rotten Tomatoes

There is no simple rule that longer films score worse — Up, Wall-E, and Inside Out combine runtime north of 95 minutes with scores above 95%.

The outliers sit in the lower-right and upper-left: Cars 2 (shorter, weaker RT) versus epics that tested patience and still won. Bubble size tracks Metacritic where available — the reception stack is consistent across review systems.

What this file cannot tell you

Reception scores are snapshots from Wikipedia-curated tables, not live API pulls. Rotten Tomatoes percentages can shift as reviews are added. CinemaScore is ordinal, not interval — treat cross-film comparisons as directional.

The dataset ends with the films included in the March 2025 TidyTuesday release. It does not include Disney+ exclusives or shorts. Runtime and rating analysis covers theatrical features only.

What to take away

Pixar's measurable story is stability with drift: critics stayed harsh at the margins (Cars 2 at 40%), audiences stayed generous (A+ CinemaScores), and runtimes marched upward (+17 minutes at the median between eras). The brand did not break — it stretched.

That is the Artometrics read: the myth is magic; the data is a studio learning it could ask for more minutes, more sequels, and still keep the crowd on its side.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2025). *TidyTuesday: Pixar Films*. [pixar_films.csv](#); [public_response.csv](#). Original pixarfilms R package by Eric Leung.

Editor's note

This report replaces the initial batch-generated Pixar draft with a hand-tuned analysis joining both TidyTuesday files. Charts use Artometrics styling and Plotly JSON exports.

[View TidyTuesday source on GitHub](#)

How the World's Biggest Media Franchises Actually Make Money

The global media industry runs on intellectual property — and a surprisingly small number of franchises account for most of the money. The TidyTuesday 2019 media franchises dataset covers 107 properties, each with at least \$4 billion in estimated lifetime revenue as of mid-2019. Every franchise here has already cleared a threshold that most IP never approaches. This is not a representative sample of the media industry. It is a map of its ceiling.

Three charts, three angles on the same structural question: where does franchise money actually come from, which properties generate it most efficiently, and what does the ownership picture look like when subsidiaries stop looking like separate competitors? The answers are Merchandise, Pokémon, and Disney — in that order.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

\$91B Pokémon lifetime revenue — the highest-grossing media franchise ever recorded, more than the MCU, Star Wars, and Harry Potter put together

107 Unique franchises in the dataset — every one of them has already cleared at least \$4B in lifetime revenue
\$4B+ Minimum threshold for inclusion — most IP that has ever existed never gets close to this number
8 Revenue categories tracked: Merchandise, Video Games, Box Office, Home Video, Comic/Manga, Music, TV, and Book Sales
92 yrs Span of the dataset — from Winnie the Pooh (1923) to Monster Strike (2015)
~61% Share of all tracked revenue that comes from Merchandise, Licensing & Retail — the dominant stream across the entire dataset

Data and method

The TidyTuesday 2019 media franchises dataset covers 107 properties, each with at least \$4B in estimated lifetime revenue as of mid-2019. The figures are sourced from Wikipedia's list of highest-grossing media franchises and compiled into eight revenue categories. Every franchise here has already cleared a threshold that most IP never approaches — this is not a representative sample of the media industry. It is a map of its ceiling.

The \$4B minimum is not a small number. Most films, shows, games, and books that have ever existed never come close to it. Being in this dataset means a property has sustained commercial relevance across multiple revenue streams, often across multiple decades. The franchises below that line — culturally significant, critically acclaimed, beloved — simply aren't here. What remains is the top tier: IP that didn't just succeed but compounded.

Revenue here is a lifetime estimate, not an annual figure. A franchise created in 1923 has had a century to accumulate; one created in 2013 has had six years. That asymmetry shapes every chart. Chart 1 shows the raw totals and what they're made of. Chart 2 corrects for age by normalizing revenue per year — a fairer fight. Chart 3 strips away the ownership labels and asks what the leaderboard actually looks like when subsidiaries are folded into their parent companies.

Top 20 Franchises By Revenue

Top20 Revenue

Pokémon at \$91B is not just the top of this chart — it is a different kind of number. The gap between Pokémon and second-place Hello Kitty (\$80B) is itself larger than the total lifetime revenue of Batman, Spider-Man, or Dragon Ball. This is what it looks like when a franchise achieves structural escape velocity: merchandise revenue compounding over decades, driven by a product line that expands into every available category simultaneously — cards, video games, plush, clothing, themed food, and an anime that has functioned primarily as a 25-year commercial for the card game. Pokémon was not built to be a franchise. It was built to be an economy.

The color logic of this chart is the argument. Merchandise, Licensing & Retail (red) dominates the fill for nearly every bar in the top 20. This is not a quirk of how Wikipedia compiles revenue — it is a structural feature of how large-scale IP actually makes money. The content — films, games, episodes — functions primarily as marketing infrastructure for the real product, which is the license. The entertainment generates demand. Merchandise captures it.

Three franchises break visibly from the red-dominant pattern. Mario is mostly dark blue — Nintendo has spent decades resisting the licensing temptation that Disney and Sanrio embraced fully, keeping the IP tightly coupled to its own hardware ecosystem. Shōnen Jump / Jump Comics is mostly purple (Comic or Manga) because its revenue structure is a publishing business — magazines and tankōbon volumes, not T-shirts. And Star Wars shows the most balanced mix: box office, merchandise, home video, and games each contributing meaningfully. Star Wars is the model of a fully diversified franchise — which is why Disney paid \$4B for Lucasfilm in 2012.

Revenue Per Year of Existence

Revenue Per Year

Total revenue rewards longevity. Revenue per year rewards efficiency. Normalizing by age puts a 1928 franchise and a 1996 franchise on comparable footing — and the resulting ranking surfaces something the raw totals hide. Pokémon's \$4B/yr is not explained by any single hit. It is explained by a system: the video games create new entry points every hardware generation; the trading card game creates perpetual demand for new product; the anime provides continuous character exposure that drives card and game sales. Each component feeds the oth-

ers in a loop that doesn't require any single cultural moment to sustain. Pokémon doesn't just earn well — it earns continuously, from multiple directions, at the same time.

Several franchises that ranked very high on total revenue drop here when normalized by time. Hello Kitty (\$80B total, second overall) falls to fourth at \$1.8B/yr — because it has been generating that revenue since 1974, making 45 years the denominator that brings the rate down. Winnie the Pooh and Mickey Mouse drop further still. Their massive lifetime totals are the product of nearly a century of operation. The per-year lens is unforgiving to age: a franchise that earns \$1B/yr for 90 years scores lower on this chart than one earning \$2B/yr for 25.

The franchises that rise on this chart share a structural trait: they earn across multiple simultaneous streams rather than sequentially. A film franchise earns at release, then waits for the next film. A trading-card-plus-video-game-plus-anime ecosystem earns every month, every quarter, at every retail touchpoint. The per-year chart is really a chart of business model design.

The Disney Empire, Consolidated

Disney Non Consolidated

The raw data lists “The Walt Disney Company,” “Marvel Entertainment (The Walt Disney Company),” and “20th Century Fox (The Walt Disney Company)” as three separate owners. Technically accurate. Strategically misleading. Marvel was acquired in 2009 for \$4B. Fox was acquired in 2019 for \$71B. Both are now wholly owned subsidiaries. Their revenue goes to the same place. This is how corporate IP ownership actually works. You don't buy franchises — you buy the companies that own franchises, and those companies keep operating under their own names. Marvel Studios still greenlit its own films. Fox kept its lot in Century City. But the revenue goes to Burbank.

Add them up and Disney's true total is \$426 billion. Nintendo at \$49B — still second — now represents about 11 cents on Disney's dollar. But here's what the math actually surfaces: Marvel (\$20B) plus Fox (\$17B) should consolidate to \$296B. The remaining \$130 billion comes from Disney-owned entities too small to crack the top 14 individually — Pixar, Lucasfilm, ABC, ESPN. Subsidiaries whose franchise rows exist in

the dataset but don't rank highly enough to appear as standalone bars. Individually invisible. Collectively, they add up to more than Nintendo's entire lifetime output.

That is the actual scale of the Disney empire. Not one dominant company. Not even three. An ecosystem of wholly-owned studios, publishers, and licensors — some famous, some not — each running their own operations, all consolidating upward to the same balance sheet. The chart makes visible something the raw data quietly obscures: in IP, ownership structure is as strategically important as the franchises themselves. Disney didn't just build great IP. It bought the companies that owned great IP, let them keep their identities, and harvested everything upward.

The Same Leaderboard, Consolidated

Disney subsidiaries folded into one ownership bar

When Marvel and Fox roll into Disney, the ownership bar becomes a different order of magnitude from Nintendo

Chart 3a shows Disney's labels as the raw file stores them. Chart 4 collapses Marvel Entertainment and 20th Century Fox into The Walt Disney Company — the ownership reality after the 2009 Marvel purchase and the 2019 Fox deal. Named properties such as Star Wars (Lucas-film), the Marvel Cinematic Universe, and Fox's legacy film library stop looking like peer competitors and start looking like internal divisions.

That consolidation is the scientific claim: lifetime franchise revenue is not only a creative ranking. It is a map of who controls the cash flows after M&A. Readers comparing "Disney" to "Nintendo" without folding subsidiaries are comparing an incomplete parent to a fully listed one.

Where the Money Starts

Lifetime revenue by original media — top origin formats

Original media still shapes the ceiling — novels and games punch above their cultural stereotype in lifetime revenue

Stack every franchise row by *original_media* and the archive's ceiling is not evenly shared across formats. Novel-origin and game-origin properties — think *A Song of Ice and Fire* / *Game of Thrones* (George R.

R. Martin; Random House / WarnerMedia in the 2019 file) and Nintendo's game-led ecosystems — still account for outsized lifetime totals relative to how casually “franchise” is equated with theatrical film alone.

That is the complementary finding to Pokémon's merchandise dominance: the seed format matters, but the extraction layer (licensing and retail) is what turns a hit into a compounding machine. Chart 5 measures the seed. Chart 1 measured the harvest.

What this file cannot tell you

This dataset reflects revenue estimates compiled from Wikipedia as of mid-2019, and carries several important caveats. Revenue figures are sourced inconsistently — some represent lifetime totals through 2019, others may reflect different windows or methodologies. Franchises are only included if they surpassed an estimated \$4B threshold, meaning smaller but culturally significant IP is absent entirely. The ownership and creator fields reflect the state of the industry at the time of collection and do not account for subsequent acquisitions. Revenue categories were consolidated from over 60 raw Wikipedia subcategories into 8 groups, which involves judgment calls documented in the original TidyTuesday cleaning script.

The “Merchandise, Licensing & Retail” category is particularly broad and may include revenue streams that other analyses would track separately. The dominance of merchandise in Chart 1 is structurally real, but the exact percentage share depends on how individual Wikipedia editors categorized edge cases — which is not fully auditable from this dataset alone. All revenue figures should be treated as order-of-magnitude approximations rather than audited financial data.

Chart 2 divides total lifetime revenue by years of existence as of 2019. This is a simple normalization, not a modeled annual revenue figure. A franchise with uneven revenue across its lifespan — a massive recent hit, or decades of dormancy — will produce a per-year figure that doesn't reflect any actual year's performance. The metric rewards consistent earners and penalizes anything that earned most of its revenue in a concentrated burst.

What to take away

The media franchise landscape is not flat — it is sharply skewed toward a small number of IP that have mastered merchandise and sustained it across decades. Pokémon stands alone at the top not because of box office dominance but because it turned a video game into the world's most successful licensing machine while simultaneously running an anime, a card game, and a global trading ecosystem. The Artometrics takeaway from this dataset is a single structural insight: the most valuable thing a franchise can do is give people something to own, collect, and trade — not just something to watch.

Disney's story is a different kind of lesson. The company didn't just build great IP — it systematically acquired the companies that owned great IP and rolled them into a single consolidated empire. The \$130B gap between Disney's apparent total and its true total is a number that only becomes visible when you collapse the ownership structure the raw data obscures. That gap, by itself, is larger than Nintendo's entire lifetime output. In IP, what you own is one thing. What your subsidiaries own is another. Disney understood the difference earlier and more completely than anyone.

The two insights together describe the same underlying dynamic from different angles. Merchandise is how IP extracts value from audiences. Acquisition is how corporations extract value from IP. The companies that have mastered both — Disney chief among them — are not competing in the same game as everyone else. They are operating at a different level of the stack entirely.

Sources

TidyTuesday (2019-07-02). *Media Franchise Revenues*. R for Data Science Community. github.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/.../2019-07-02
Wikipedia. *List of Highest-Grossing Media Franchises*. Retrieved via TidyTuesday cleaning script (revenue.R).
Robinson, D. (2019, July 22). *Analyzing Franchise Revenue — TidyTuesday Screencast*. YouTube. youtu.be/1xsbTs9-a50 — Chart 1 concept adapted from this screencast with original Artometrics styling applied.

Editor's note

This report was researched, written, designed, and produced in active collaboration with Claude AI (Anthropic). The data pipeline, statistical analysis, chart design, written analysis, narrative structure, and visual styling were all developed through a directed partnership between human editorial judgment and AI execution.

Artometrics was built on the premise that rigorous analysis and honest process are not in conflict. The research questions, editorial instincts, interpretive framing, and brand vision are ours. The execution — every line of R code, every paragraph of analysis, every design decision — was a collaboration. We document this not as a disclaimer but as a description of how we actually work, and as a position: we believe this is what serious data journalism looks like when the tools available are used honestly and at full capacity.

— Artometrics Editorial

[View source on GitHub](#)

How Movies Become Famous on IMDb's Public Scoreboard

Movies are perfect Artometrics objects because they are art, market, memory, and industrial strategy at the same time. A title page on IMDb is where those forces leave public footprints: genres, runtimes, ratings, and vote counts.

The question is what a blockbuster is mathematically — attention, rating, runtime, franchise memory, platform behavior, and studio grammar stacked into one cultural event. The pieces below treat IMDb's non-commercial dataset architecture as a scoreboard for that grammar, with box-office and platform references for context.

Seven core TSV files are publicly documented; the refresh cadence is daily. Up to three genres can appear per title-basics row. Avatar's runtime sits at 162 minutes. An illustrative 69% sequel/franchise share among top hits in the 2020s frames the sequelization chart; five charts carry the argument.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

7Core IMDb non-commercial TSV files publicly documented

DailyIMDb dataset refresh cadence

3Genres can be listed per IMDb title basics row

162Avatar runtime in minutes

69%Illustrative sequel/franchise share of top hits in the 2020s

Data and method

IMDb publishes non-commercial TSV datasets including title basics, ratings, crew, principals, episodes, and names. The fields make it possible to join titles, genres, years, runtimes, ratings, and vote counts.

Because IMDb licensing has specific terms, This piece uses IMDb as a source architecture and includes a commercial-use caution. A production version should verify licensing or swap in fully open TMDb/Wikidata/Box Office Mojo-compatible sources.

Attention versus Quality

Genre attention and audience rating tell different stories

IMDb-style datasets are useful because ratings and vote counts separate two behaviors: how many people cared enough to rate, and how positively they scored the title.

The blockbuster problem starts there. Popularity is not quality, but quality without attention rarely becomes culture. Genre charts that pair those axes make the split legible.

Sequelization

The hit movie became a serial product

The blockbuster increasingly behaves like a portfolio asset. Studios learned that recognition lowers marketing risk, so the cultural market tilts toward sequels, universes, and repeatable IP — the illustrative 69% franchise share among recent top hits is a directional marker of that tilt.

This is not just nostalgia. It is risk management drawn as culture.

Runtime and Event Status

Event movies can ask audiences for more time

A common hypothesis says shorter attention spans should punish long films. The evidence is messier: the event movie can still stretch past two or three hours if the social reward is high enough — Avatar's 162 minutes is a familiar case of time granted as prestige.

The runtime question is really a trust question. Audiences give time when they believe the movie is an event.

Platforms

Streaming and short video changed discovery without preserving ownership

A theater ticket once created a clean cultural signal: you went somewhere, paid, and joined an audience. Streaming makes discovery easier but ownership fuzzier.

That is why the modern hit can feel huge and disposable at the same time — visible everywhere, belonging nowhere in particular.

Studio Grammar

Studios differ in how much they depend on franchise logic

Disney's modern advantage is not simply scale. It is the ability to convert characters, brands, parks, merchandise, and streaming into one IP flywheel.

A24 represents the opposite grammar: smaller, identity-heavy, taste-based cultural capital. Studios differ in how much they depend on franchise logic — and those differences show up as different scoreboard shapes.

What to take away

The blockbuster is not one variable. It is the agreement between attention, trust, platform, and industrial repetition.

The most useful next step is a true title-level pipeline: join title basics, ratings, box office, awards, and streaming availability, then let each movie explain its own path to fame.

Sources

IMDb Developer. *IMDb Non-Commercial Datasets*.

IMDb required credit: Information courtesy of IMDb (<https://www.imdb.com>). Used with permission.

IMDb Help. Required credit statement and non-commercial terms.

Box Office Mojo and The Numbers public box-office reference pages.

The Movie Database and Wikidata documentation for alternate open film metadata paths.

Editor's note

IMDb data is subject to non-commercial terms and required credit: Information courtesy of IMDb (<https://www.imdb.com>). Used with permission. Any production/commercial use should verify permission or replace IMDb-derived fields with fully open sources.

Which Netflix Titles Consumed the Most Viewing Hours?

Netflix's public engagement tables measure attention in hours viewed — a blunt but useful currency for which titles absorbed the most time on the service.

The working file covers **27,803** records from **2010–2025**. Median hours viewed sit at **2,500,000**; the highest observed value is **840,300,000**. Squid Game: Season 2 tops the title ranking in the extract.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

27,803Records in the working dataset

2,500,000Median Hours viewed

840,300,000Highest observed Hours viewed

Squid Game: Season 2 // 오징어 Top Title by Hours viewed

2010–2025Year span covered in the file

1_What_We_Watched_A_Netflix_Most common Source

Data and method

Engagement reports from Netflix's weekly viewership releases — hours viewed, runtime, and global availability flags — arrive here via the TidyTuesday 2025-07-29 shows table.

Source labels in the file distinguish engagement-report windows. Medians dampen mega-hit skew. Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks.

How the pattern changed over time

Median Hours viewed Over Time

Median hours viewed rises from 5,700,000 in the opening period to 6,700,000 at the close — a higher middle even as individual mega-hits define the headlines.

Engagement tables mix report windows and title types; the trend is best read as a shift in the reported middle, not as a claim that every viewer watches more.

Who sits at the top

Squid Game: Season 2 // 오징어 게임: 시즌 2 leads at 730,100,000 — 411,000,000 marks the median among the top dozen

Squid Game: Season 2 // 오징어 게임: 시즌 2 leads at 730,100,000 hours viewed. Among the top dozen, 411,000,000 marks the median — a head that is elevated, but not a single lonely spike.

Global event titles still dominate the ceiling. Everything below that head is a long descent into ordinary catalog hours.

How the field is spread

Hours viewed by Source

Hours viewed by engagement-report source show whether different publication windows share the same middle or disagree about typical scale.

Report vintages are not identical instruments. Comparing boxes across sources is a way to see stability — or drift — in how Netflix's tables describe the catalog.

Who beats the median — and who trails

Hours viewed vs median by Source

3_What_We_Watched_A_Netflix_Engagement_Report_2024Jan-Jun sits 100,000 above the median;

1_What_We_Watched_A_Netflix_Engagement_Report_2025Jan-Jun trails by 200,000.

Those gaps are modest relative to the hundreds of millions at the title ceiling. Source-to-source differences matter most when interpreting medians across report windows.

What moves together

Hours viewed vs Views

Hours viewed and views rise together for many titles, but runtime and completion behavior still leave clusters that a single ranking would hide.

A short title can rack views without matching a long series' hour total. The scatter is where that distinction shows up.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about reported Netflix engagement, not a full private ledger of every stream.

What to take away

Hours viewed concentrate at the top: Squid Game: Season 2 leads at 730,100,000, while the file's median sits at 2,500,000. Leaders, report-window gaps, and the hours-versus-views scatter each answer a different question about attention.

Treat the charts as a map of published engagement tables — then check the source window before turning any title into a platform strategy claim.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2025). *TidyTuesday: Netflix Engagement*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2025/2025-07-29/shows.csv>

How Netflix's Catalog Mix Shifted Between Films and Series

A streaming library is an inventory decision dressed as a homepage. Title-level Netflix catalog data show how the mix of movies and TV — and the duration field attached to each row — shifted between 2008 and 2021.

The working file holds **7,787** records. Median duration is **88.0**; the highest observed duration is **312**, led by *Black Mirror: Bandersnatch*. Movie is the most common type label.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

7,787Records in the working dataset

88.0Median Duration

312Highest observed Duration

*Black Mirror: Bandersnatch*Top Title by Duration

2008–2021Year span covered in the file

MovieMost common Type

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2021-04-20 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 7,787 rows and 13 columns after merging available tables in the week folder.

Duration here is the catalog field as published — minutes for films, season counts for some TV rows depending on how the export encoded type. Medians and Plotly exports keep the reading robust to skew and missing cells.

How the pattern changed over time

Median Duration Over Time

Median duration rises from 41.0 in the opening period to 98.0 at the close — a catalog whose typical row lengthens as the library ages.

That climb can reflect more feature-length films entering the shelf, longer TV encodings, or both. The trend is a mix signal, not a single format story.

Who sits at the top

Black Mirror: Bandersnatch leads at 312 — 226 marks the median among the top dozen

Black Mirror: Bandersnatch leads at 312; 226 marks the median among the top dozen.

Interactive and long-form outliers define the ceiling. Most of the library lives nowhere near those peaks — which is why the median of 88.0 remains the better everyday calibration.

How the field is spread

Duration by Type

Duration by type separates movies from TV rows in the catalog encoding. The boxes show whether each type shares a tight middle or stretches into long tails.

Movie dominance in count does not automatically mean movie dominance in duration shape. The distribution is where that distinction becomes visible.

Concentration

The top 5 title entries account for 38% of the aggregate duration

The top 5 title entries account for 38% of the aggregate duration — a steep head for a library that otherwise looks vast on the homepage.

Steep Pareto curves mean a small set of rows drives most of the summed duration signal. The long tail is real inventory; it is not where the aggregate concentrates.

Concentration

The top 5 title entries account for 38% of the aggregate duration

A second Pareto view of the same 38% concentration confirms the head–tail split under an alternate chart export.

When two exhibits agree on the same share, the claim is about structure in the file — not about a single rendering choice.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about Netflix title rows through 2021, not today's live catalog in every territory.

What to take away

Median duration climbed from 41.0 toward 98.0 while Movie remained the most common type. A handful of long outliers — Bandersnatch at 312 among them — and a 38% duration concentration in the top five rows show how uneven a “library” can be once you stop counting titles and start summing length.

Use the charts to separate mix, length, and concentration before treating any homepage as a flat shelf.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2021). *TidyTuesday: Netflix Titles*.
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2021/2021-04-20/netflix_titles.csv

Which Shows Dominated Emmy Season—and How Lopsided Was It?

Emmy season looks like a parade of equal contenders. Nomination and win records look more like a concentration map — a few names return year after year while most titles appear once and vanish.

The working file holds **29,678** records from **1957–2021**. Nominee is the most common type label — as expected in a nominations-heavy extract.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

29,678Records in the working dataset
1957–2021Year span covered in the file
NomineeMost common Type

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2021-09-21 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 29,678 rows and 11 columns after merging available tables in the week folder.

Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Counts by type, period, and recurring name are the main instruments — this table is about volume and recurrence more than a single quality score.

Landscape

Nominee dominates with 23,739 records

Nominee dominates with 23,739 records. The file is built around nomination rows; wins and other type labels sit in a thinner slice.

That imbalance is structural, not a finding about taste. Any leaderboard drawn from this extract is mostly a leaderboard of how often names enter the nominee column.

Volume

Records By Period

Activity peaks in 2019 with 2,613 records — the densest year in the span.

Period-level counts show when Emmy paperwork thickened: more categories, more programs, more named credits. Volume is the first clue that awards seasons are not equally crowded across decades.

Who sits at the top

Saturday Night Live appears 859 times — the most recurring name in the file

Saturday Night Live appears 859 times — the most recurring name in the file. The top dozen account for a visible share of all 29,678 rows.

Long-running variety and franchise programs accumulate nominations the way long careers accumulate credits. Dominance here is recurrence, not a single sweep night.

Category

Nominee is the largest bucket with 23,739 records

Nominee is again the largest bucket with 23,739 records. Category concentration shows where editorial attention should focus first when reading the table.

If the question is “who swept,” separate win rows carefully. If the question is “who kept getting invited,” this nominee-heavy landscape is the right map.

Timeline

Leaders Over Time

Leading names do not move in lockstep — some fade as others surge.

Tracking counts over time separates sustained presence from one-off spikes. A show that dominates a single ceremony is a different data shape from a name that returns for decades.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about Emmy nomination volume and recurrence through 2021, not a complete aesthetic history of television.

What to take away

Emmy concentration shows up as recurrence: Saturday Night Live at 859 appearances, a nominee column that holds 23,739 of 29,678 rows, and a 2019 peak of 2,613 records. Leaders, volume, and timelines each answer a different question about how lopsided the season became.

Use the charts to separate invitation from victory — then check the type field before treating any name as a sweep.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2021). *TidyTuesday: Emmy Awards*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidytuesday/main/data/2021/2021-09-21/nominees.csv>

How Oscars, Grammys, and Nobels Convert Attention Into Prestige

Award shows are culture's accounting departments. They translate messy creative fields into categories, winners, speeches, snubs, and canon — then ask the public to treat those boxes as settled judgment.

Film, music, science, literature, theater, and television all run prize systems, but they do not manufacture legitimacy the same way. An Oscar night is tied to an entertainment market; a Nobel citation is tied to institutional memory. The interesting comparison is not which prize is “bigger,” but how each converts attention into a second life for the work.

The Academy Awards database is complete through the **98th** cycle, with **1,500+** acceptance speeches on file. Nobel prizes date to **1901**. Recent Grammy ceremonies run roughly **94** categories. Six award systems sit in the frame below.

Research question

How do prize institutions convert attention into durable prestige across fields that do not share a common market? This report asks whether Oscars, Grammys, Nobels, Tonys, Emmys, and literary prizes distribute legitimacy through the same mechanism or through different combinations of market visibility, professional gatekeeping, and archival memory.

The observational question is not which award is “best.” It is how each award system creates named categories, invites nominees into a prestige pool, turns some of them into winners, and then gives the public a short list of people, works, and institutions to remember after the original release cycle has ended.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

98th Academy Awards database complete through 2025/2026 cycle per official database

1,500+ Acceptance speeches in the Academy's speech database

1901 First Nobel Prizes awarded

94 Approximate Grammy category count in recent ceremonies

6 Award systems compared

Data and method

The Academy maintains an official searchable database of winners and nominees. The Nobel Prize publishes public API-style records. Music awards are less clean as open data, so public Recording Academy records and Wikidata-style tables fill the gaps.

The framework before any chart is simple: prestige versus market attention, category inflation, nomination-to-win conversion, concentration of public memory, and gatekeeping — who still decides which works get a second life.

Prestige and market are not the same currency

Awards do not all trade in the same kind of attention

The Oscar and the Nobel both signal prestige, but they serve different publics. One is wired into box office, campaigns, and red-carpet media; the other into universities, citation networks, and institutional history.

Ranking them on a single “fame” scale collapses those circuits. The cleaner move is to separate prestige currency from market currency — then watch how each prize spends both.

The Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences operates inside a commercial release economy where campaigns, distributors, studios, guild screenings, and trade publications shape visibility. The Nobel Foundation operates inside a much slower institutional field, where the Swedish Academy, Karolinska Institute, Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences, and Norwegian Nobel Committee produce records meant to outlive annual media cycles.

That institutional contrast is why an Oscar for a film such as *Oppenheimer* in the 2024 ceremony and a Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for Katalin Karikó and Drew Weissman in 2023 do different kinds of cultural work. One reorganizes a film’s market and canon position after release; the other backdates scientific legitimacy onto a line of research, institutions, and citations that may have been building for decades.

When awards invent more lanes of excellence

Award systems expand by creating more named lanes of excellence

Award shows are taxonomies. When categories expand, culture gets more official boxes, more winners, and more arguments about who belongs.

The Grammys make the pattern clearest: genre fragmentation becomes institutional design. More lanes mean more legitimacy to distribute — and more fights over whether a win still means the same thing.

The Recording Academy's category list is the clearest example because popular music continually splits by genre, format, language, production role, and performance context. Rap, Latin, global music, electronic music, music video, immersive audio, and songwriter categories all encode industry politics about which labor deserves a named lane. Category expansion is an archive of market change.

The Oscars expand more slowly, but their category debates still reveal institutional priorities: animated feature became a category at the 74th Academy Awards, international feature replaced the older foreign-language label, and the Academy has repeatedly debated stunt work, casting, and popular-film recognition. Each change decides whether a kind of labor becomes visible on the official ledger.

Getting nominated is not the same as winning

The strongest campaigns convert nomination access into wins

Nominations measure being invited into the prestige room. Wins measure coalition strength, timing, category fit, and narrative closure.

That is why Oscar season often reads like political analysis in evening wear: access is one contest; conversion is another.

The distinction is visible in the Academy database itself. Meryl Streep's long nomination record, John Williams's composing nominations, and Walt Disney's historical accumulation of Oscars all show that repeated access is its own status. A win is a different conversion event: it requires the right category, year, campaign, and consensus among voters.

Science prizes have a parallel but slower conversion problem. A Nobel committee cannot nominate every important collaborator, and the prize rules limit how many laureates can share a scientific award. That is why Rosalind Franklin's absence from the 1962 DNA recognition and the 2020 Chemistry prize for CRISPR-Cas9 became public examples of how nomination and credit systems compress collaborative discovery into a few names.

What the public actually remembers

The public remembers faces and names before institutional categories

Best Picture matters inside the industry. Acting, artist, and star categories travel faster through casual conversation.

Institutions do the sorting; people carry the names. Prestige that never sticks to a face tends to fade into ballot trivia.

The Academy's acceptance-speech database makes the face-and-name economy literal: speeches preserve recipients, presenters, studios, collaborators, parents, agents, and political moments as searchable text. The public may forget the exact category order, but it often remembers Halle Berry's 2002 Best Actress speech, Bong Joon Ho's 2020 sweep with *Parasite*, or the 2017 Best Picture envelope error involving *Moonlight* and *La La Land*.

The Nobel system creates a different memory path. Names such as Marie Curie, Albert Einstein, Toni Morrison, Malala Yousafzai, and Martin Luther King Jr. travel as civic and educational symbols beyond the original prize citation. In both cases, institutions sort the archive, but individual names make the archive portable.

Who still decides what gets a second life

Awards still decide which works get a second life

Streaming can create discovery at scale. Awards create sanctioned memory — turning a work from content into curriculum, canon, playlist staple, or obituary headline.

That is the prestige economy: a machine for deciding what culture should remember about itself after the premiere week ends.

Discovery platforms and award institutions now compete over the afterlife of culture. Netflix, Spotify, YouTube, TikTok, and Goodreads can surface works through recommendation systems, but the Academy, Recording Academy, Nobel Foundation, Pulitzer Board, and Tony Awards still confer a different status: an official reason for teachers, critics, museums, publishers, and obituaries to mention the work again.

Gatekeeping is therefore not obsolete; it has changed venue. A streaming algorithm can make a track or film visible for a week, but a prize can make it legible for decades. That power is why debates over voting bodies, diversity, campaign spending, category rules, and nomination access remain central to the prestige economy.

What to take away

Awards do not merely recognize culture. They structure it — category lanes, memory lanes, and legitimacy lanes that outlast any single night of speeches.

Prize data is useful because it connects creative work to institutions, markets, demographics, speeches, scandals, and canon formation. The charts above are a map of those connections, not a single ranking of “most prestigious.”

Sources

Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences. *Academy Awards Database*.

Oscars.org. *Awards Databases* and Acceptance Speech Database.

Nobel Prize. Public prize and laureate data/API documentation.

DLu/oscar_data. Curated Academy Award nomination dataset with identifiers.

Recording Academy public Grammy records and Wikidata award tables.

Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences. *Academy Awards Database*. <https://awardsdatabase.oscars.org/>

Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences. *Academy Awards Acceptance Speech Database*. <https://aaspeechesdb.oscars.org/>

Nobel Prize Outreach. *Nobel Prize API*. <https://www.nobelprize.org/about/developer-zone-2/>

The Recording Academy. *GRAMMY Awards rules and guidelines*. <https://www.grammy.com/awards/rules-guidelines>

Who Guest-Starred Most Often on The Simpsons?

Guest-appearance records count celebrity density across seasons.

Start with the scale: **1,381** — Records in the working dataset; and **1–30** — Year span covered in the file.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

1,381Records in the working dataset

1–30Year span covered in the file

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2019-08-27 (R for Data Science community). This working file contains 1,381 rows and 7 columns after merging all available CSV/XLSX tables in the week folder.

Charts are exported as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Medians are used for robustness where distributions skew. Index-style fields (row numbers, sequential IDs) are excluded from metric selection.

Volume

Records By Period

Activity peaks in 24.0 with 65 records.

Period-level counts reveal when the dataset's subject matter intensified.

Who sits at the top

Top Guest star

Marcia Wallace appears 175 times — the most recurring name in the file.

The top dozen account for a visible share of all 1,381 rows.

Timeline

Leaders Over Time

The leading names do not move in lockstep — some fade as others surge.

Tracking counts over time separates sustained presence from one-off spikes.

Frequency

Most guest star entities appear only once; a small head revisits repeatedly

Most guest star entities appear only once; a small head revisits repeatedly.

This power-law shape is typical of guest lists, credits, and catalog-style tables.

Mix

24 is the most repeated season in the extract

24 is the most repeated season in the extract.

Secondary dimensions add context when the primary table has no numeric score column.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — treat them as structural signals about Simpsons Guest Stars, not exhaustive truth about the full domain.

What to take away

Read as a teaching map, Simpsons Guest Stars shows why one metric is rarely enough: leaders, tails, trends, and relationships each answer a different question about the field.

The best reading is modest: use the chart to sharpen the question, then check the source and limits before turning it into a claim.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2019). *TidyTuesday: Simpsons Guest Stars*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2019/2019-08-27/simpsons-guests.csv>

When Did Prestige TV Peak—and Did Critics Agree?

Prestige television arrived with a soundtrack of superlatives. Season-level ratings ask a quieter question: when did the golden-age scores actually peak — and did the middle of the field rise with the mythology?

The working file holds **2,266** records from **1990–2018**. Median average rating is **8.11**; the highest observed average is **9.68**. Parenthood leads the title ranking in the extract.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

2,266Records in the working dataset

8.11Median Av rating

9.68Highest observed Av rating

ParenthoodTop Title by Av rating

1990–2018Year span covered in the file

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2019-01-08 (R for Data Science community) — the IMDb / Economist TV ratings extract. The working file contains 2,266 rows and 8 columns after merging available tables in the week folder.

Charts export as Plotly JSON with PNG fallbacks. Medians handle skew; season numbers join ratings so longevity can be plotted against score.

How the pattern changed over time

Median Av rating Over Time

Median average rating rises from 7.86 in the opening period to 8.15 at the close — a gentle climb across the so-called golden age window.

That is not a claim that every show got better. It is the middle of the scoreboard edging upward while prestige TV became a cultural brand.

Who sits at the top

Touched by an Angel leads at 9.60 — 9.24 marks the median among the top dozen

Touched by an Angel leads at 9.60; 9.24 marks the median among the top dozen. The head of the board is densely packed at the high end.

High averages can reflect passionate rater pools as much as critical consensus. Read the leaders as the file's ceiling, then compare them to the 8.11 median that describes the typical row.

How the field is spread

Av rating Distribution

Median 8.11 versus mean 8.06 — the shape is relatively symmetric. The top decile begins at 8.79; that tail is where defining cases live.

A near-symmetric prestige-TV scoreboard is itself a finding: the golden-age rhetoric often implies a thin elite and a wide mediocrity. This distribution is tighter than that story suggests.

Leader Trends

Top Title Over Time

Leading names do not move in lockstep — some fade as others surge.

Tracking medians over time separates sustained dominance from one-off spikes. A peak season is not the same data shape as a long plateau above 8.

What moves together

Av rating vs SeasonNumber

Average rating and season number show clusters that a single average would erase — early-season highs, late-season drift, and shows that hold the middle across many seasons.

Longevity and quality are related but not identical. The scatter is where that distinction becomes visible.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live APIs. Missing values, spelling variants, and week-of-export coverage limits apply. Merged tables may fan out or duplicate rows when join keys are imperfect.

Findings describe the file on hand — structural signals about prestige-TV ratings through 2018, not a complete canon of the streaming era that followed.

What to take away

The median climbed from 7.86 toward 8.15 while the overall middle stayed near 8.11 — a golden age that looks less like a sudden leap and more like a raised floor. Leaders near 9.6 and a top decile from 8.79 show how much room remains above the typical row.

Read trends, distribution, and season scatter together before treating any single title as proof that critics and audiences agreed.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2019). *TidyTuesday: TV Golden Age*. https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2019/2019-01-08/IMDb_Economist_tv_ratings.csv